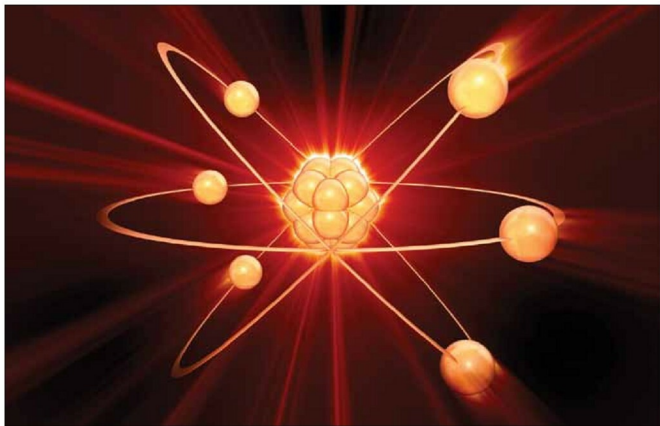


NANOTECHNOLOGY

THE LORD OF SMALL THINGS!

While many hail nanotechnology as ‘the’ phenomenon of the new age, and one of the most potent emerging forces in the field of technology, there are others who dismiss it as a subject fit only for research labs. This article aims to explore the truth behind these claims, and track the direction in which nanotechnology is moving



■ VANDANA SHARMA WITH INPUTS
FROM JANANI GOPALAKRISHNAN
VIKRAM

“Everything can be made in some way better – stronger, lighter, cheaper, easier to recycle – if it’s engineered and manufactured at the nanometre scale.”

– Stan Williams
director-Quantum Science Research
HP Labs

The 21st century can easily be called the era of portable devices that are lighter, smaller and a whole lot powerful in configuration than their predecessors. All this has largely been rendered possible with the size of the processor shrinking to the nanometre scale. These small-sized processors, also called microprocessors, have enabled

the electronics manufacturers to build products that are smaller in size, have faster processing speeds and are powerful. However, experts view this development more as the continuation of existing microelectronics rather than a breakthrough in the nanotechnology space. They believe that this is merely a small application of nanotechnology and doesn’t represent even an iota of the potential that